



God decides to
bring about the
existence of
contingent things

And this fact must be necessary, or contingent.

If it is necessary, then, again, premise (1) of our initial argument is false.



could this be?

And if it is contingent, then the PSR must have some explanation. But what

present the dilemma for Leibniz's argument discussed at the end of

lecture. I include it here for those interested in pursuing this issue

further $\rightarrow$ it is purely optional.]

[This is the end of the main lecture. What follows is another way to

samenpoint.

This is a complex line of thought. Here's a different way to get at basically the



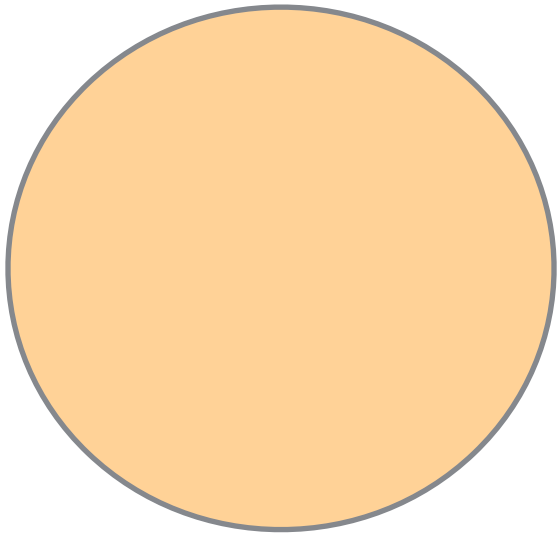
Leibniz's
argument



the
PSR



objections
to the
PSR



Guides to

bring about the

existential

continuing things

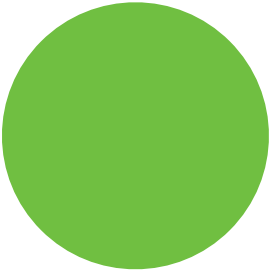
simply be some event, like the Big Bang, which is not a plausible candidate to

Last time we considered an objection to Aquinas' assumption that if a first

be Good.

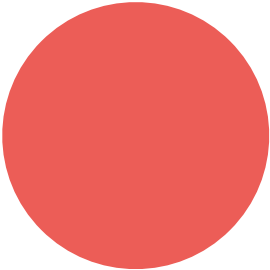
cause exists, then God exists: the objection was that the first cause could







Leibniz's
argument





... we cannot find in any of the individual things, or even in the entire collection and series of things, a sufficient reason for why they exist.

Let us suppose that a book on the elements of geometry has always existed, one copy always made from another. It is obvious that although we can explain a present copy of the book from the previous book from which it was copied, this will never lead us to a complete explanation, no matter how many books back we go, since we can always wonder why there have been such books.

What is true of these books is also true of the different states of the world ... however far back we might go into previous states, we will never find in those states a complete explanation for why there is a world at all, and why it is the way it is.



